

Library, it can call the API functions and use XFBML which can either be displayed inline on the page or dynamically created via the library.

1.5 Application architecture

All Facebook applications have the same basic architecture to interoperate with the Platform. For this reason, Facebook provides a Facebook Developer application to allow developers to make new applications and add in the details where they are hosted. Each application is issued a secret identifying keys, and developers are required to enter URLs for how users and Facebook access the application.

This does not mean that Facebook actually host developer's applications. It simply acts as a proxy instead so that when the user visits the Canvas Page URL, Facebook creates an outer frame and then calls the application's Canvas Callback URL to get information to display.

1.5.1 Secret Keys

Whenever an application is created on the Facebook Developer platform, it is given a public and private key pair. The public key is called the API key, and the private key is called the Secret key. These keys verify that all calls made to the Facebook API are from that very application. It is an important security feature and developers should protect their Secret keys and report their loss if they are ever compromised. Otherwise, any other application can start making calls masquerading as that application, and modify or even delete user data.

1.5.2 Canvas Page URL

The Canvas Page URL is the URL that Facebook users use to get to the application. It is of the format <http://apps.facebook.com/canvaspageurl>. It needs to be unique.

1.5.3 Canvas Callback URL

The Canvas Callback URL is the URL of your server where your application resides. Facebook makes calls to this URL whenever it needs to display an application page, or when a user adds or removes the application, or when it needs to update its cache. The server hosting the Canvas Callback URL should be able to handle the callbacks using whatever web server or language the developer deems appropriate. Facebook sends the set of data as POST variables to the Canvas Callback URL, which contains information about the viewing user, the session, and the application.